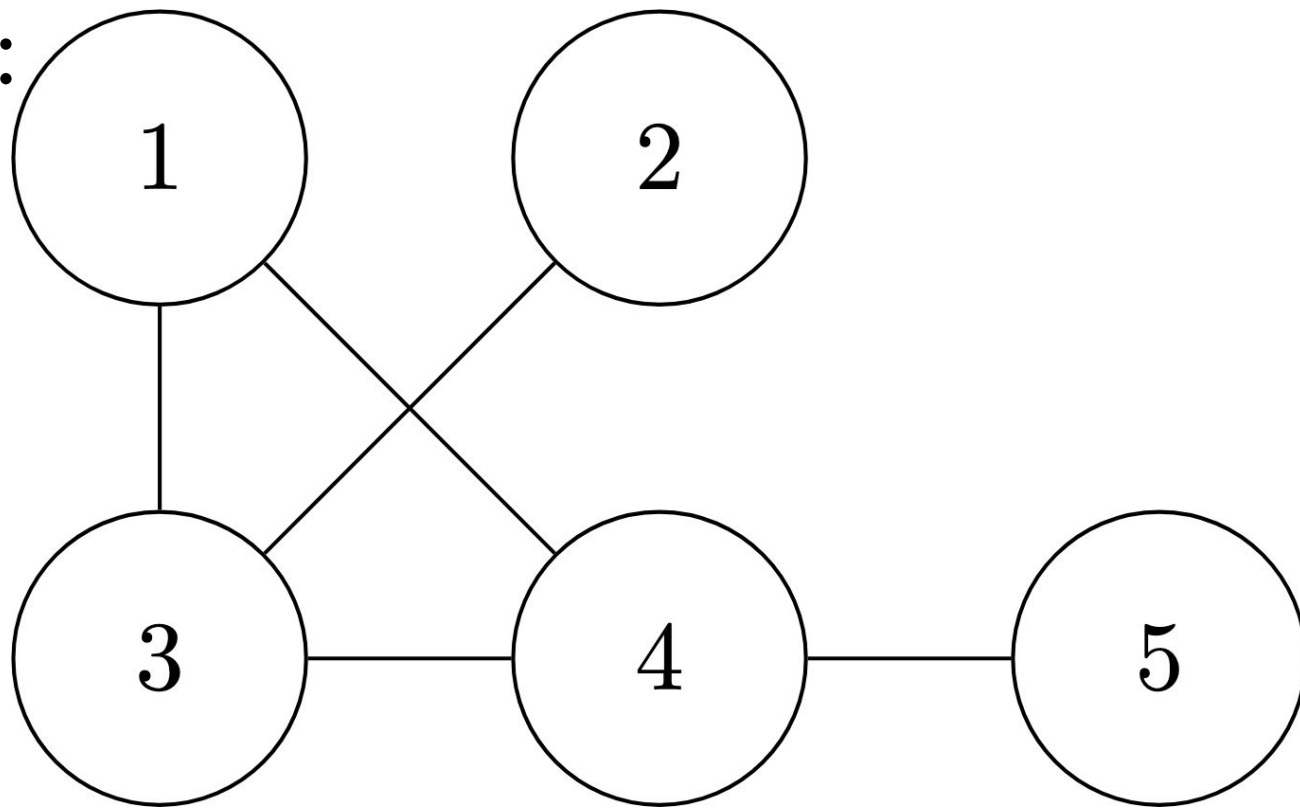


Bell Pair Extraction and Bottlenecks in Grids and Related Networks

Lillian Hart, Megan Hunleth, Alan Whitman
Mentor: Derek Zhang

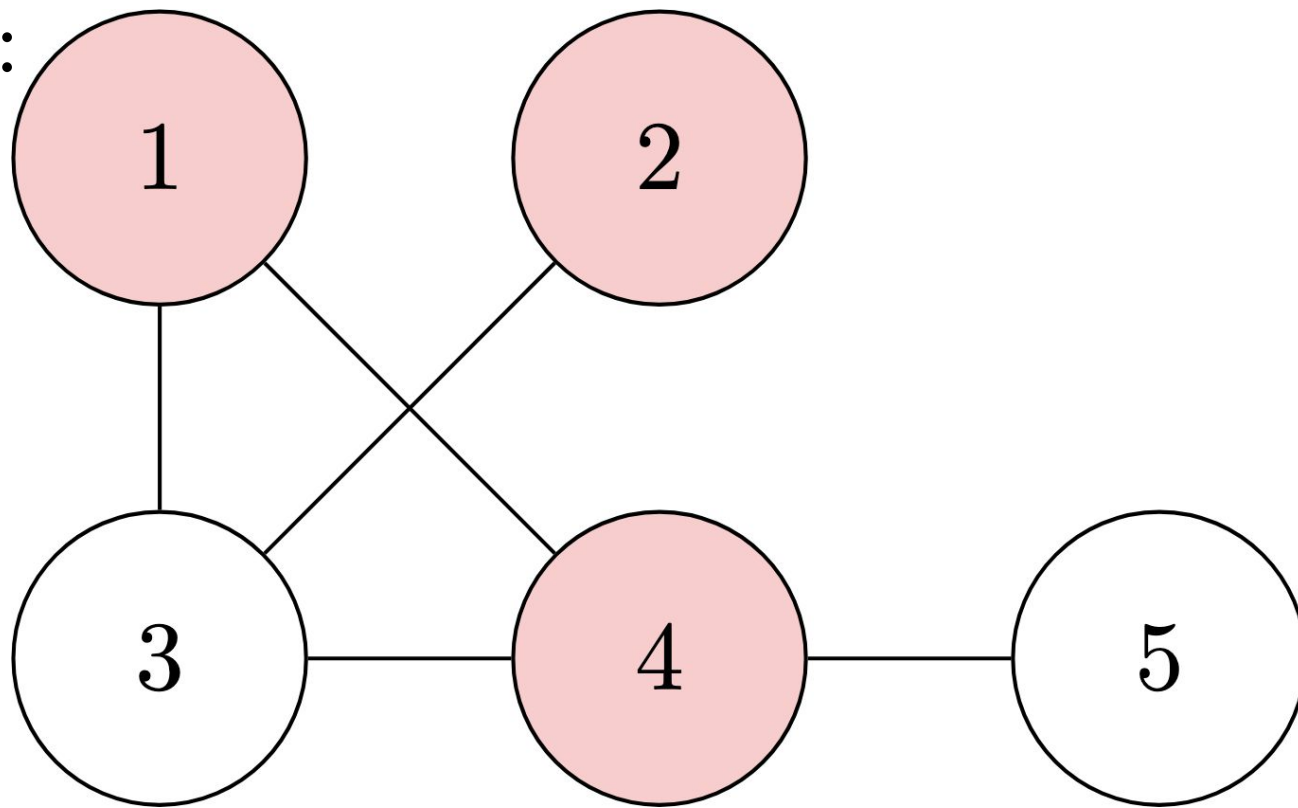
Definitions

G :



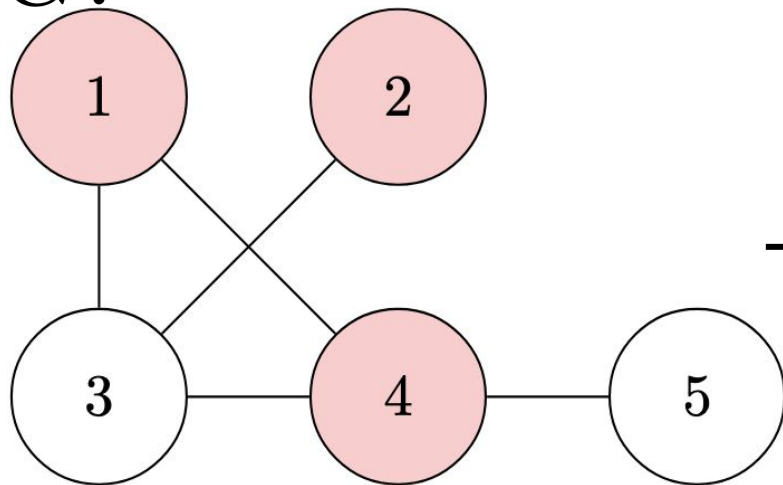
Definitions: Neighborhood

N_3 :

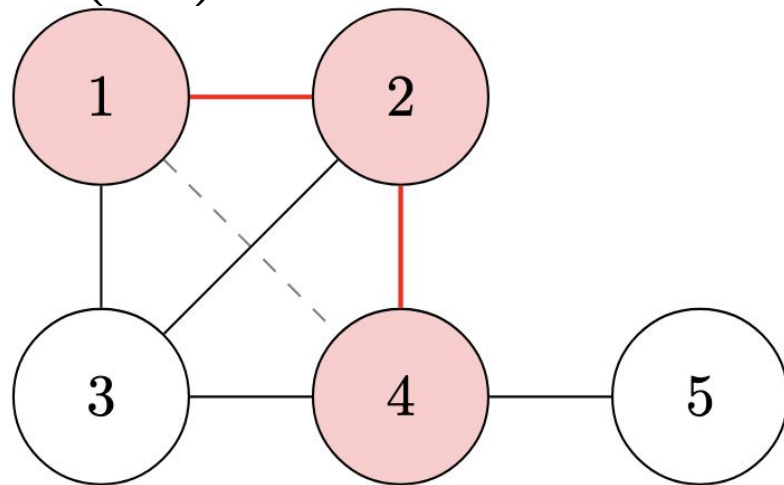


Definitions: Local Complementation (τ operation)

G :



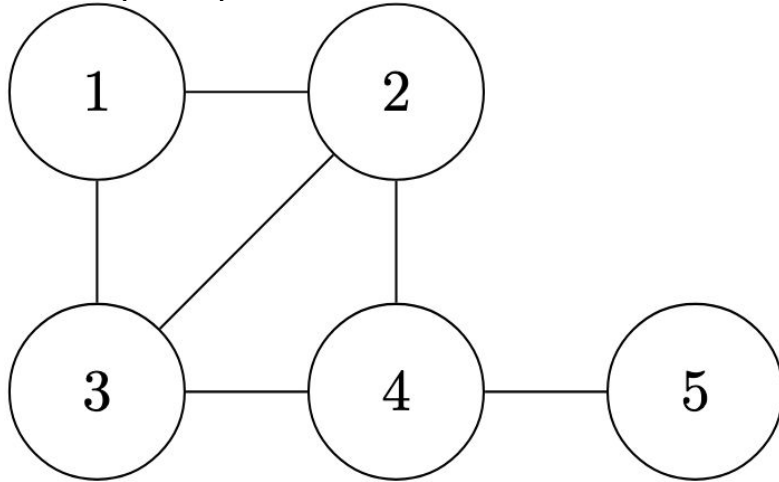
$\tau_3(G)$:



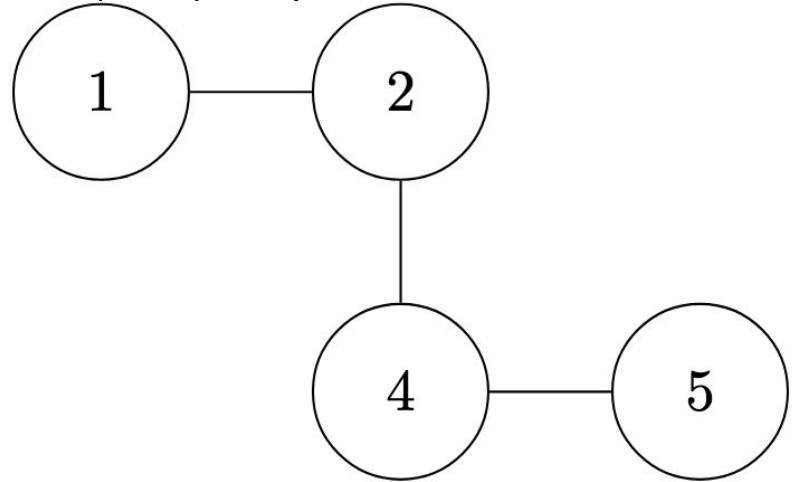
Neighborhood of vertex 3

Definitions: Vertex Deletion

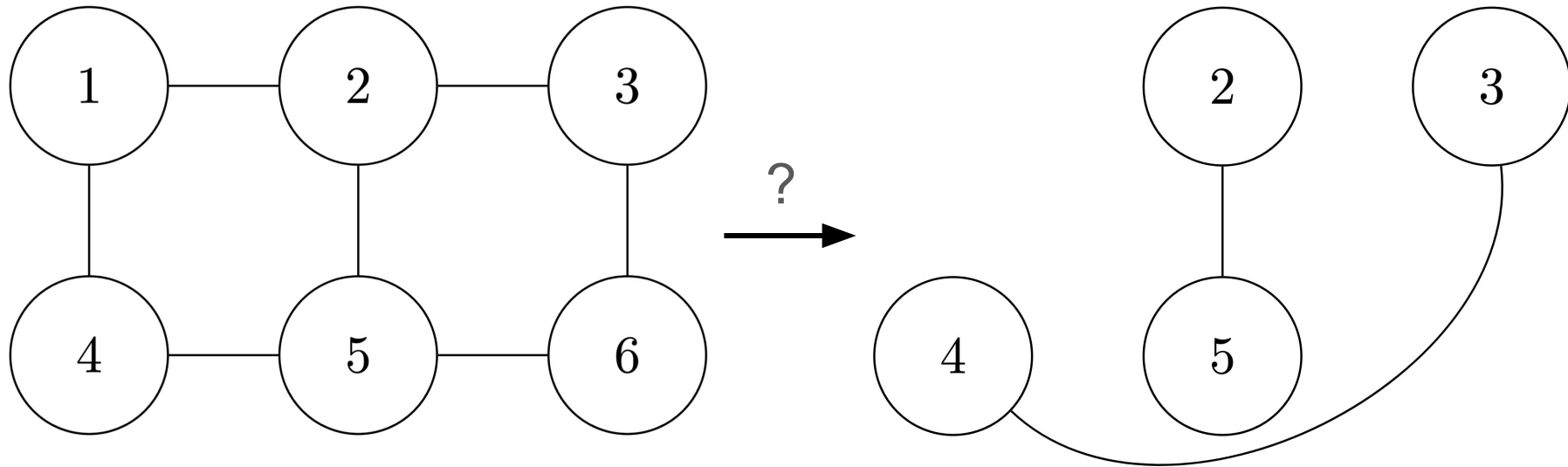
$\tau_3(G)$:



$\tau_3(G) \setminus 3$:



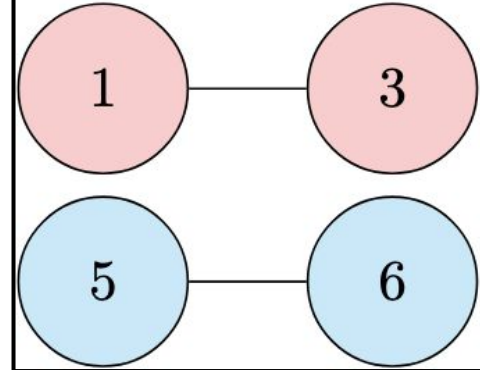
Definitions: Vertex-Minor Problem



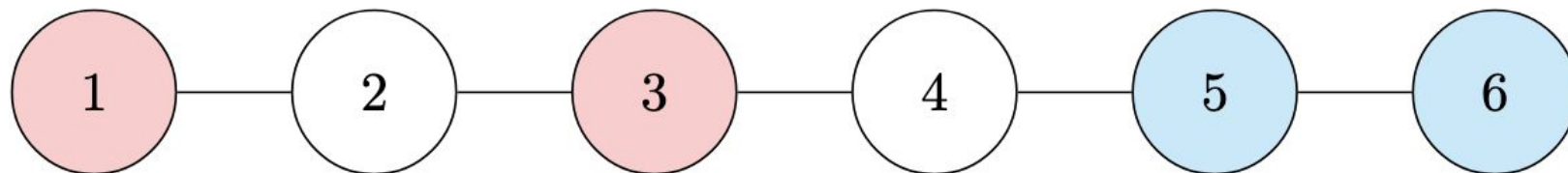
Operations: local complementation & vertex deletion

Example 1

Goal:
(Bell pair graph)

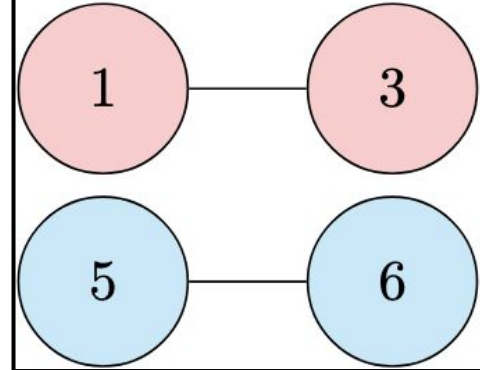


G :

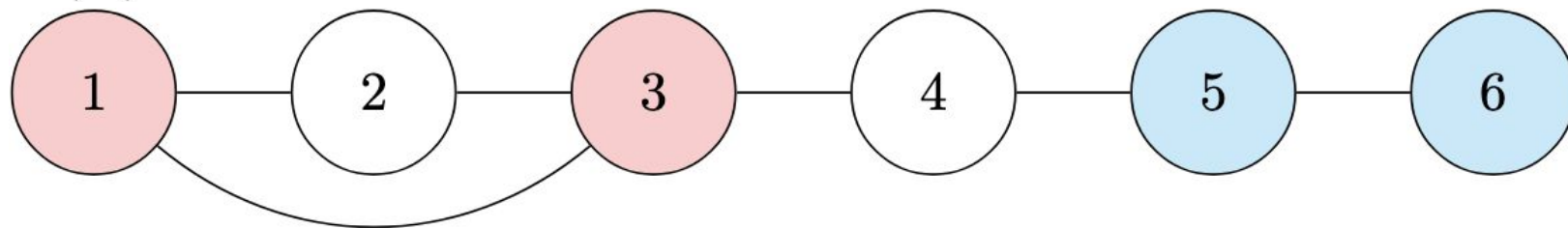


Example 1

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(Bell pair graph)

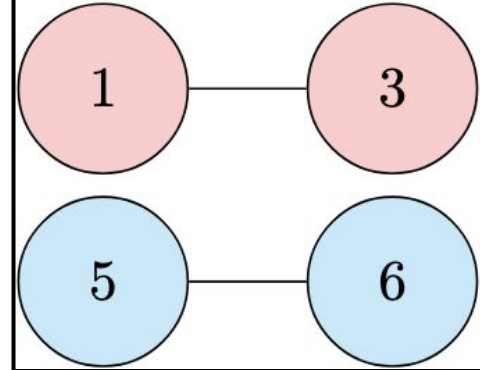


$\tau_2(G)$:

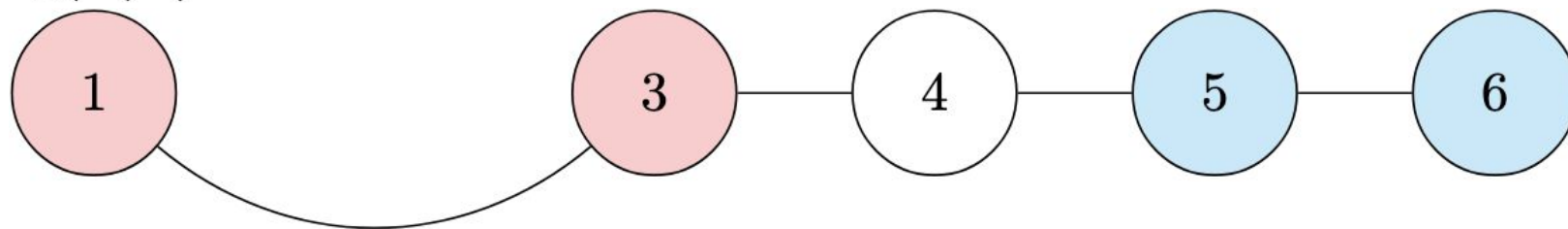


Example 1

Goal:
(Bell pair graph)

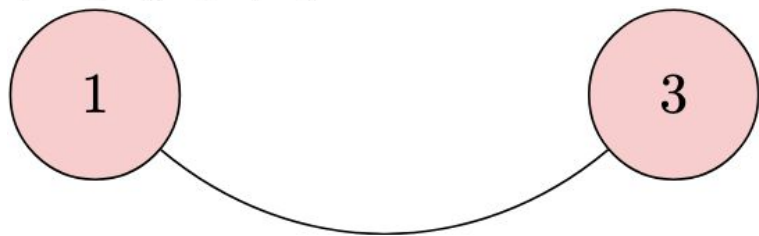


$\tau_2(G) \setminus 2$:

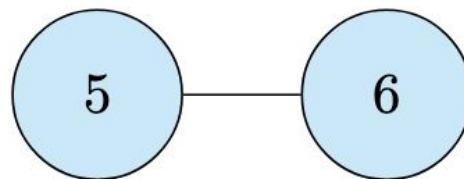
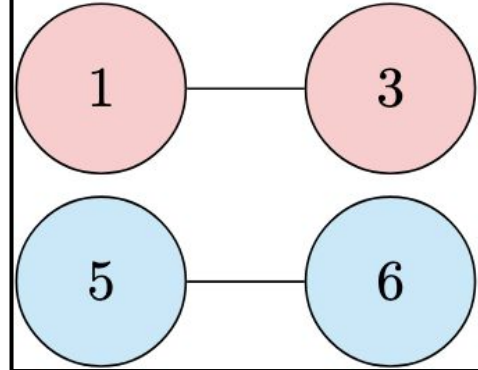


Example 1

$(\tau_2(G) \setminus 2) \setminus 4$:

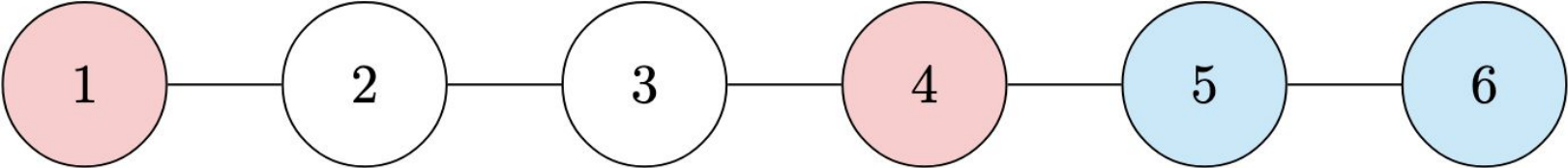
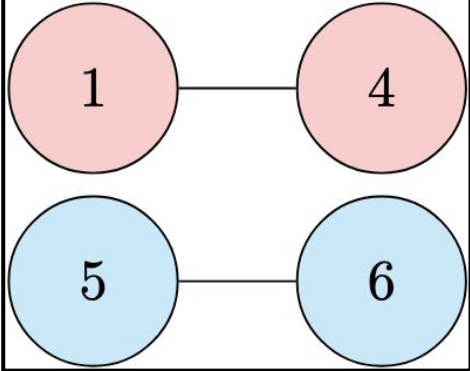


Goal:
(Bell pair graph)



Example 2:

Goal:
(Bell pair graph)

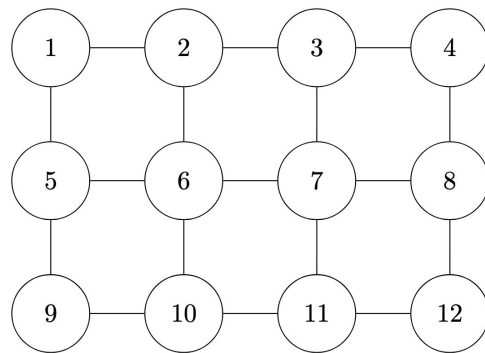
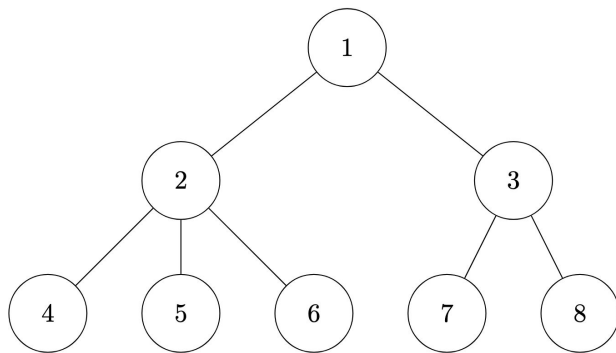
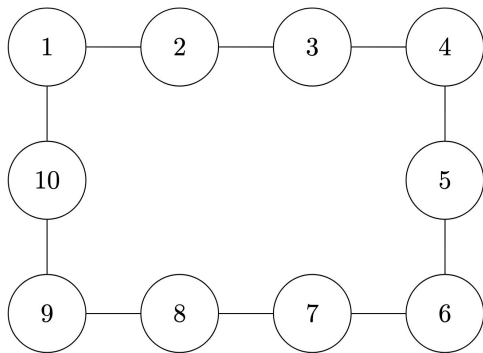


Quantum Computing/Science Motivation

- Goal: Enable reliable quantum communication between distant computers/qubits
- Problem: Create special pairs of connected qubits (bell pairs) between chosen points in a quantum network
 - A quantum network can be thought of as connected quantum computers/qubits
- Solution: represent a quantum network as a graph where:
 - Vertices represent qubits
 - Edges represent quantum links (entanglement)
- We can only modify the network specified operations
 - Local Clifford operations
 - Pauli measurements
 - Classical Communication
- Ideally, we want to generate multiple Bell pairs simultaneously to support tasks like quantum teleportation
- Qubit-minor problem: Can the quantum network be transformed to create the desired pattern of connections?
 - Qubit-minor problem = vertex-minor problem (Dahlberg & Wehner 2018)

Past Results

- Some cases of ring & line graphs ([Hahn, Eisert, & Pappa 2022](#))
- Some cases of grids ([Mannalath & Pathak 2023](#))
- Solved ring, line, & tree graphs ([Zhang 2025](#))

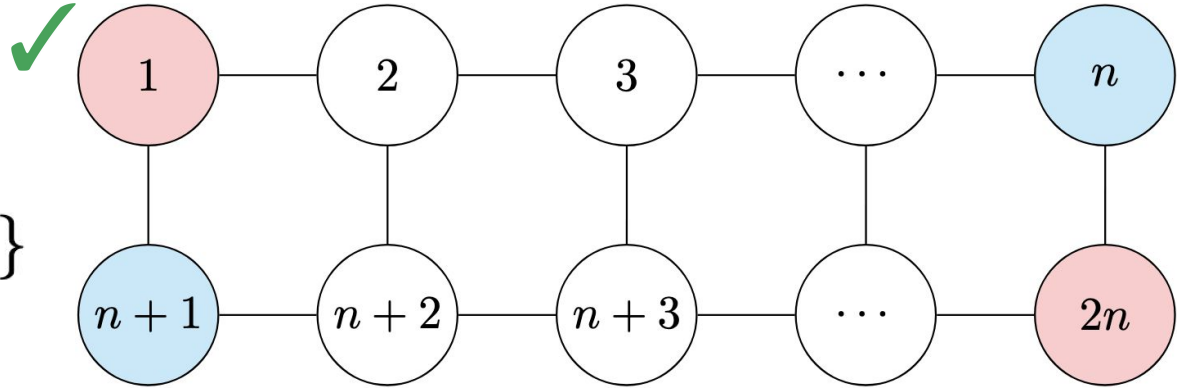


2xn Results - Mannalath & Pathak 2023

n odd:

- Can extract

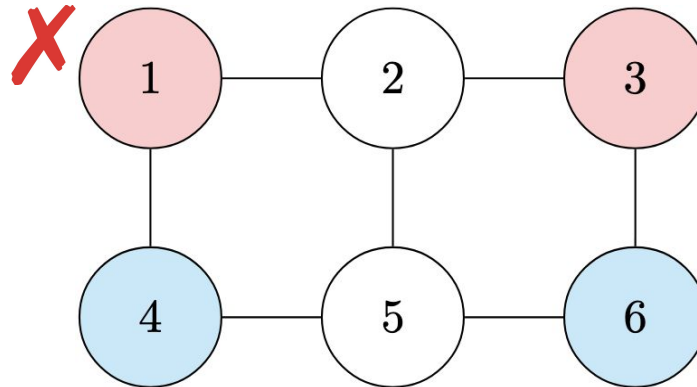
$\{1, 2n\}$ & $\{n, n+1\}$



- Cannot extract

$\{1, 3\}$ & $\{4, 6\}$

when $n = 3$

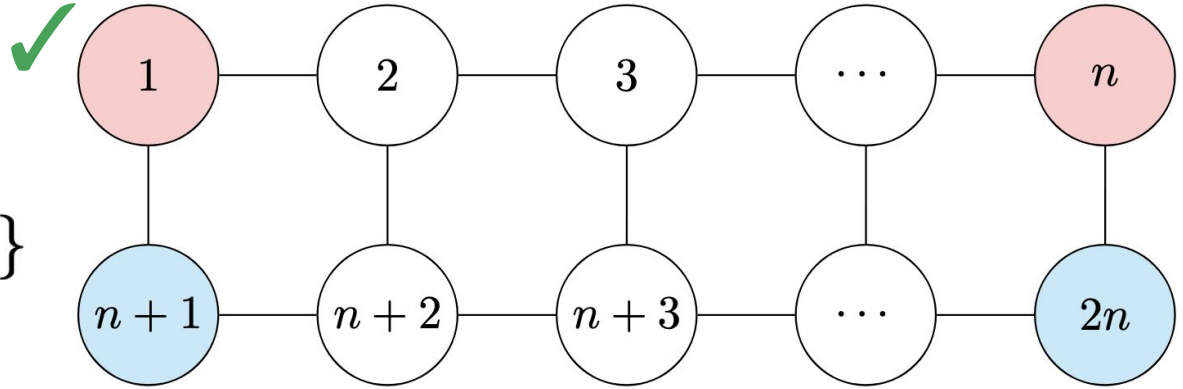


2xn Results - Mannalath & Pathak 2023

n even:

- Can extract

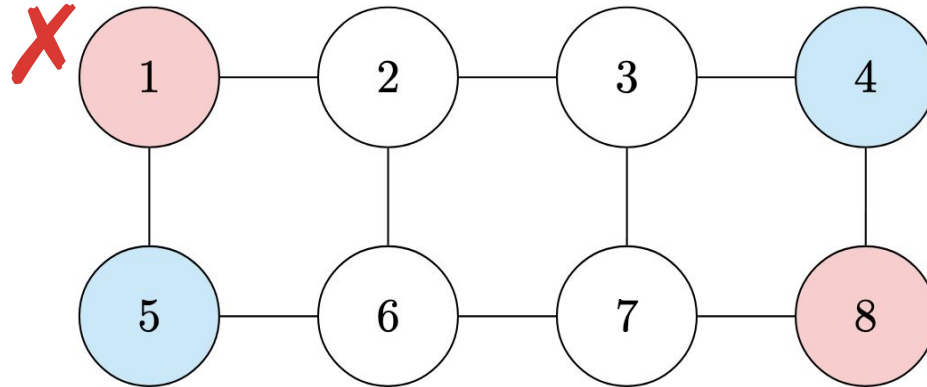
$\{1, n\}$ & $\{n, n+1\}$



- Cannot extract

$\{1, 8\}$ & $\{4, 5\}$

when $n = 4$

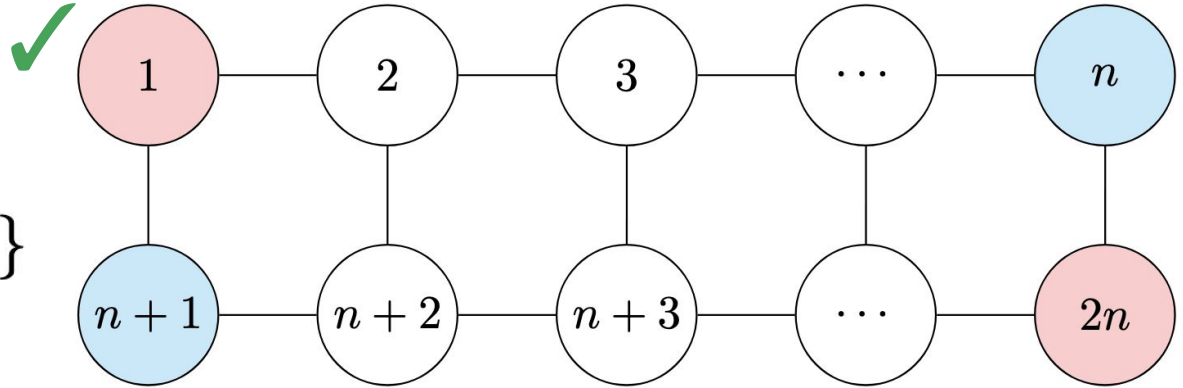


2xn Results - New

$$n > 4$$

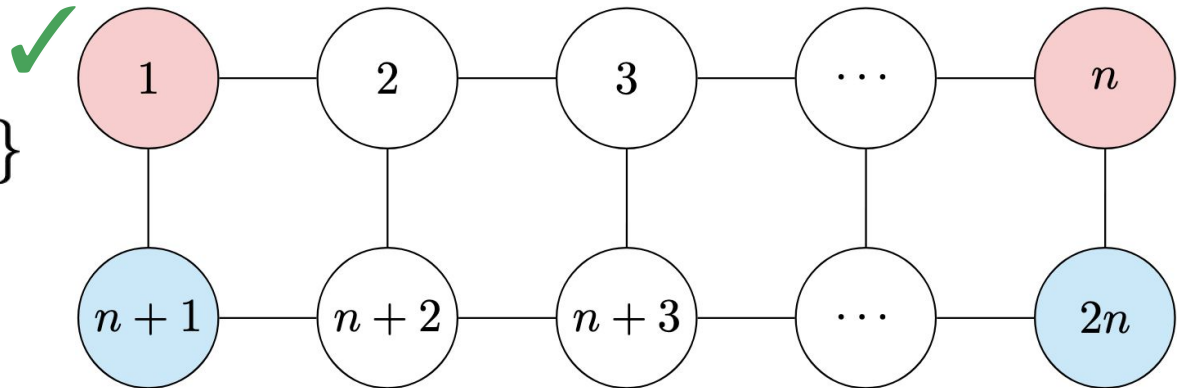
- Can extract

$$\{1, 2n\} \& \{n, n+1\}$$

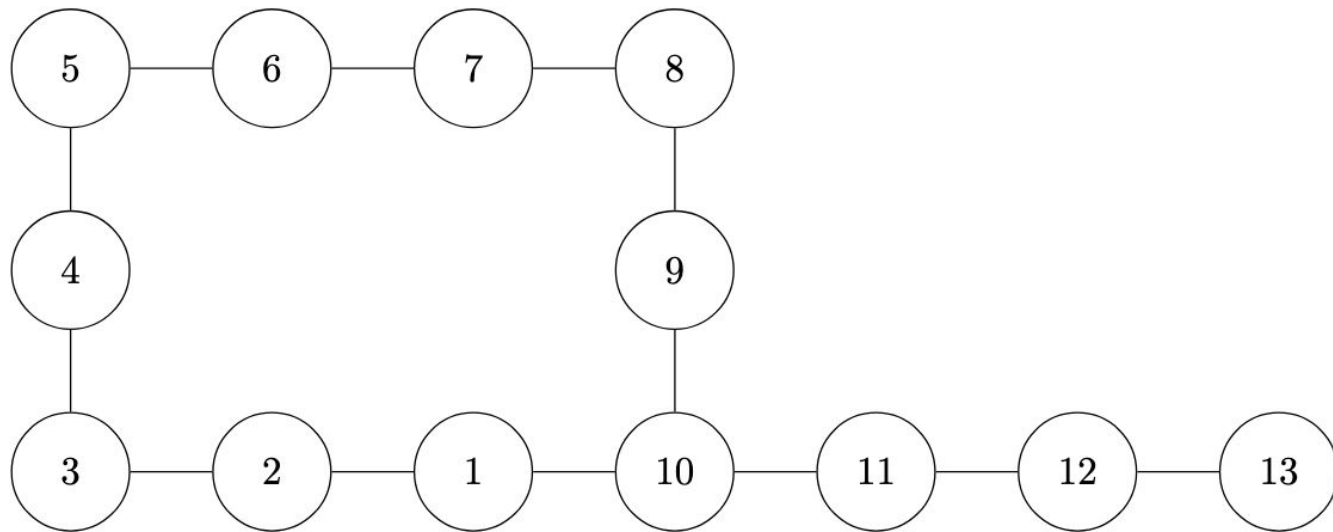


- Can extract

$$\{1, n\} \& \{n+1, 2n\}$$

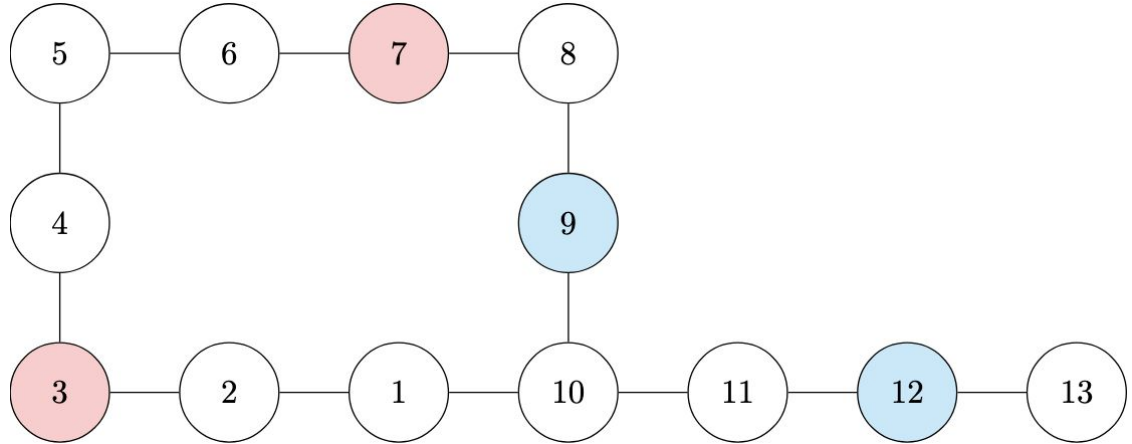


Tadpole Graphs



Tadpole Graphs

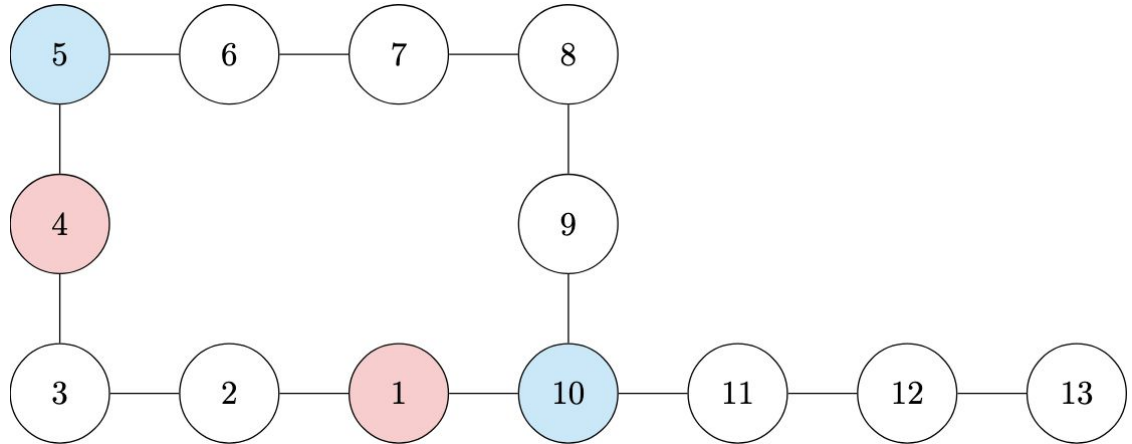
Can extract iff paths are
non-adjacent or a special
case is satisfied:



Tadpole Graphs

Can extract iff paths are non-adjacent or a special case is satisfied:

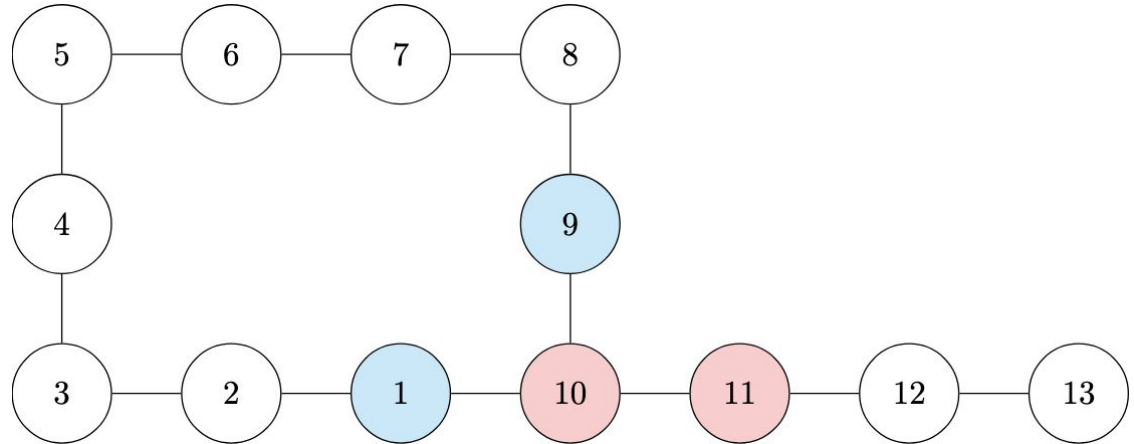
- all in ring, no 3 consecutive, paths do not cross



Tadpole Graphs

Can extract iff paths are non-adjacent or a special case is satisfied:

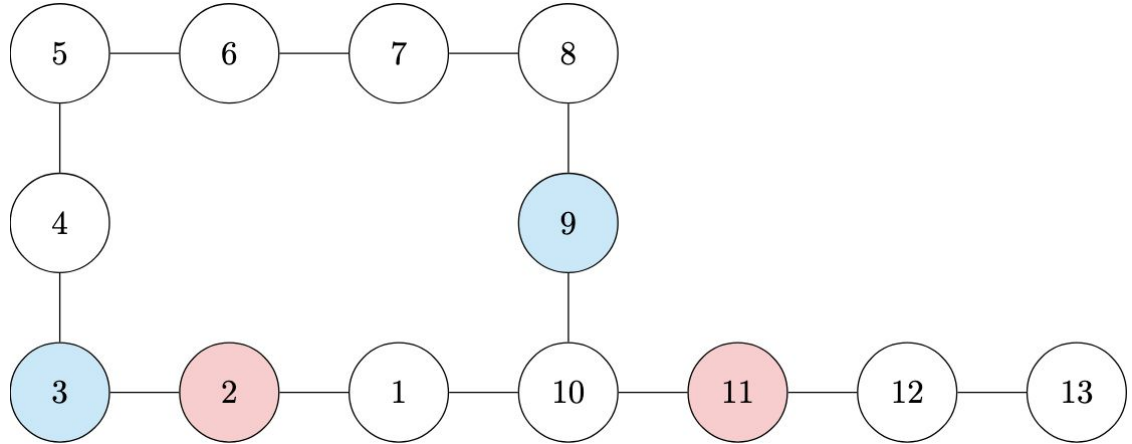
- exactly 3 vertices in ring including vertex 10, paths do not cross, and all 4 are not consecutive



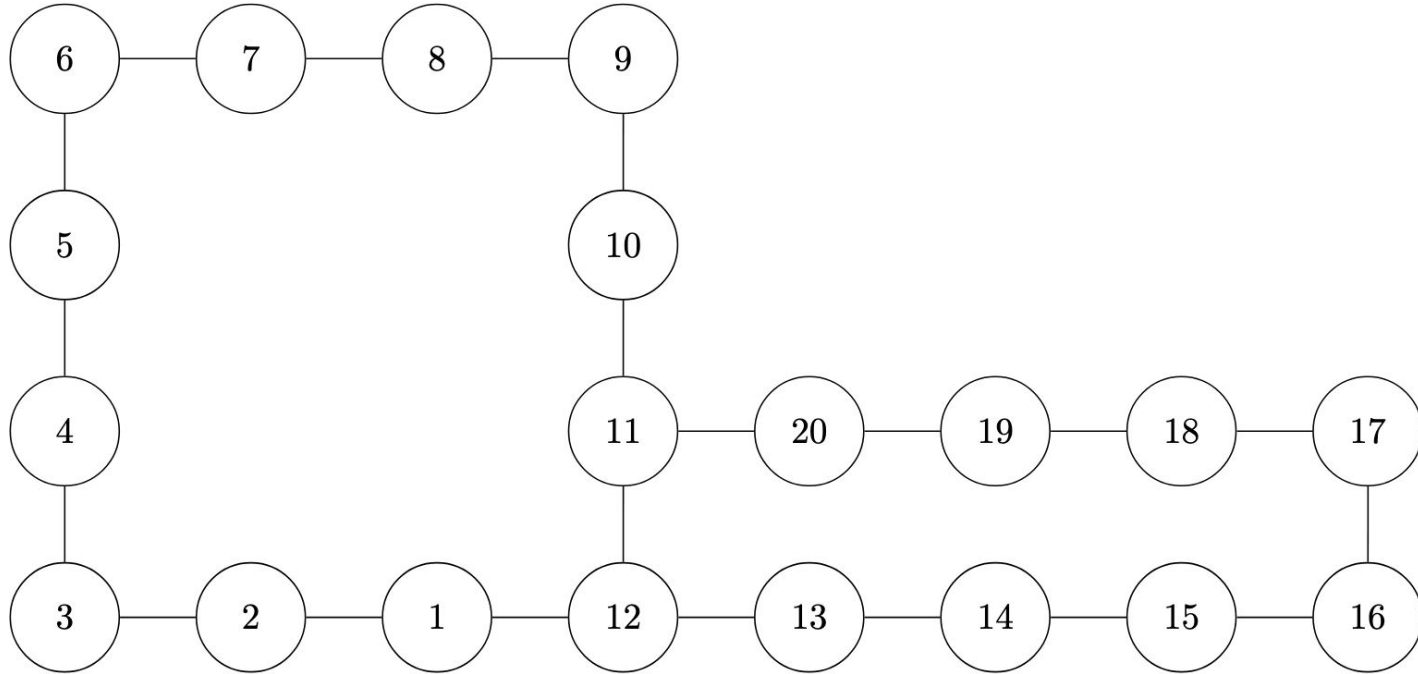
Tadpole Graphs

Can extract iff paths are non-adjacent or a special case is satisfied:

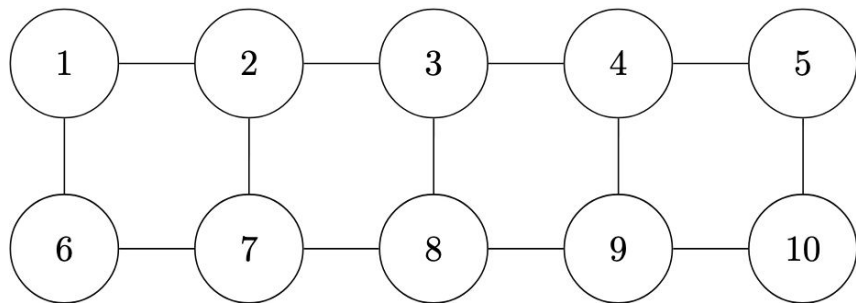
- exactly 3 vertices in ring excluding vertex 10, paths do not cross, and no 3 of the nodes in the ring plus node 10 are consecutive



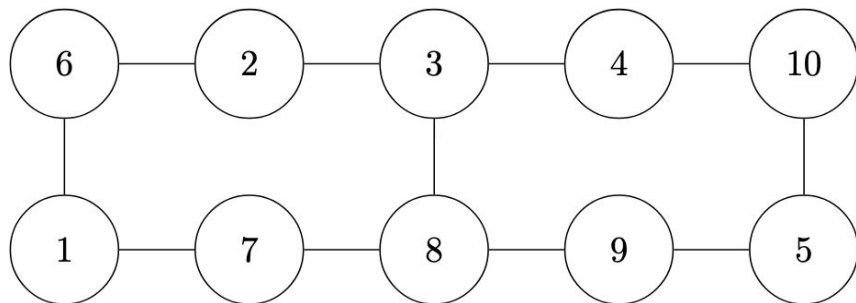
Double Ring Graphs



Corollary to 2x5 Grid



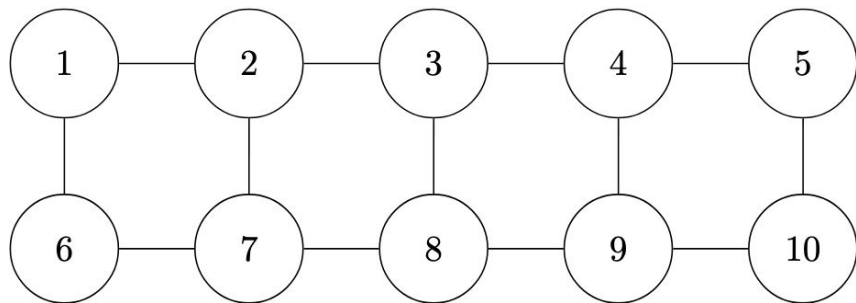
$\downarrow \tau_1 \circ \tau_2 \circ \tau_1 \circ \tau_{10} \circ \tau_9 \circ \tau_{10}$



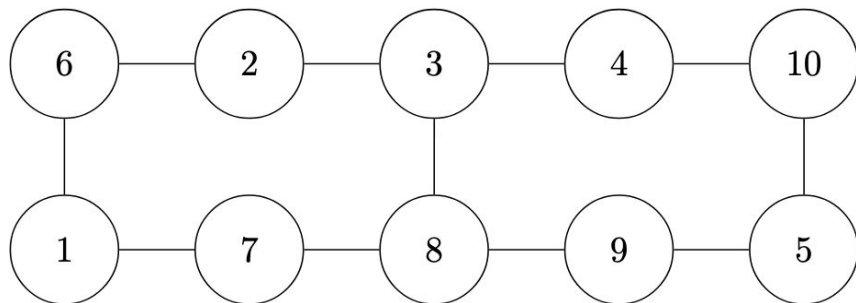
		<i>b</i>							
		1	2	4	5	6	7	9	10
<i>a</i>	1		✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✓	✓
	2	✓		✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✓
	4	✓	✓		✓	✓	✗	✓	✗
	5	✓	✓	✗		✓	✓	✗	✗
	6	✓	✗	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓
	7	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗		✓	✓
	9	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓		✗
	10	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓	

(a) Extracting Bell pairs $\{a, 3\}, \{b, 8\}$

Corollary to 2x5 Grid



$\downarrow \tau_1 \circ \tau_2 \circ \tau_1 \circ \tau_{10} \circ \tau_9 \circ \tau_{10}$



		<i>b</i>							
		1	2	4	5	6	7	9	10
<i>a</i>	1		✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗
	2	✓		✗	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗
	4	✗	✗		✓	✗	✗	✓	✗
	5	✗	✗	✓		✗	✗	✗	✓
	6	✓	✗	✗	✗		✓	✗	✗
	7	✗	✓	✗	✗	✓		✗	✗
	9	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗		✓
	10	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✓	

(b) Extracting Bell pairs $\{a, b\}, \{3, 8\}$

3xn Results

- We looked at the border cases of a $3 \times n$ grid
- These seemed to be the most useful since most interior case can be transformed into border cases
- We were able to solve all of the “side” border cases

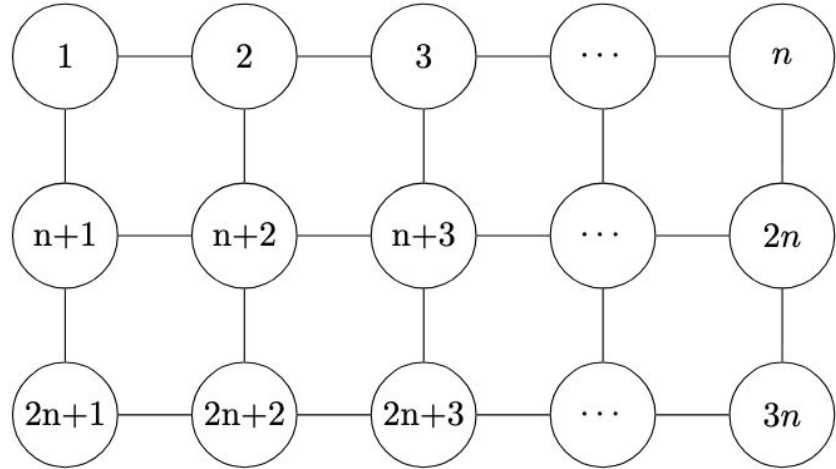


Figure 1: $3 \times n$ Grid

3xn Results

We can simultaneously extract all non-crossing side bell pairs:

- $\{1, n\}$ & $\{2n+1, 2n\}$ for $n > 1$
- $\{1, n\}$ & $\{n+1, 2n\}$ for $n > 3$
- $\{1, n\}$ & $\{2n+1, 2n\}$ for $n > 3$
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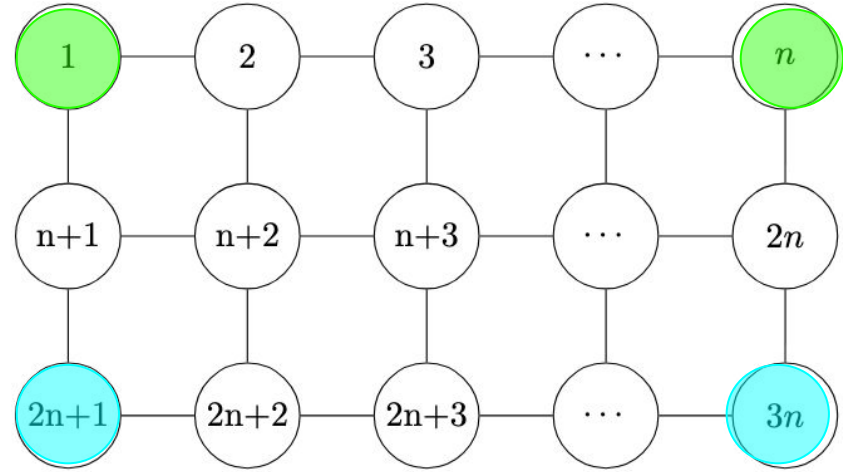


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*many of these results can be applied to further similar combinations of the graph based off of symmetry.

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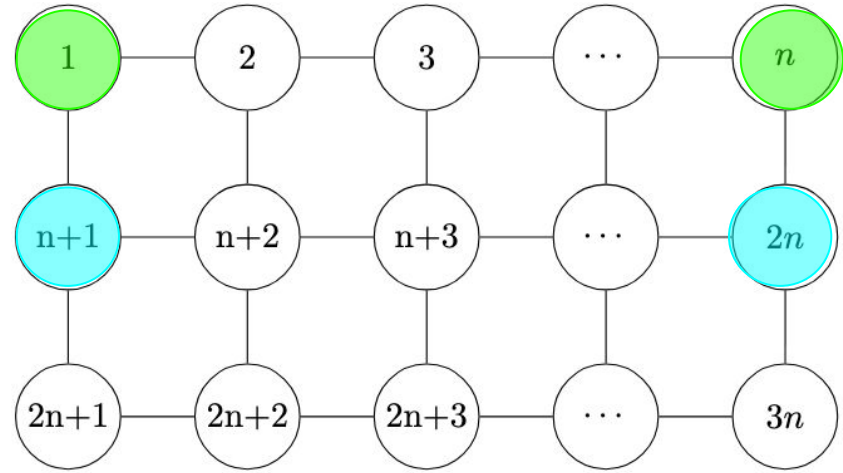


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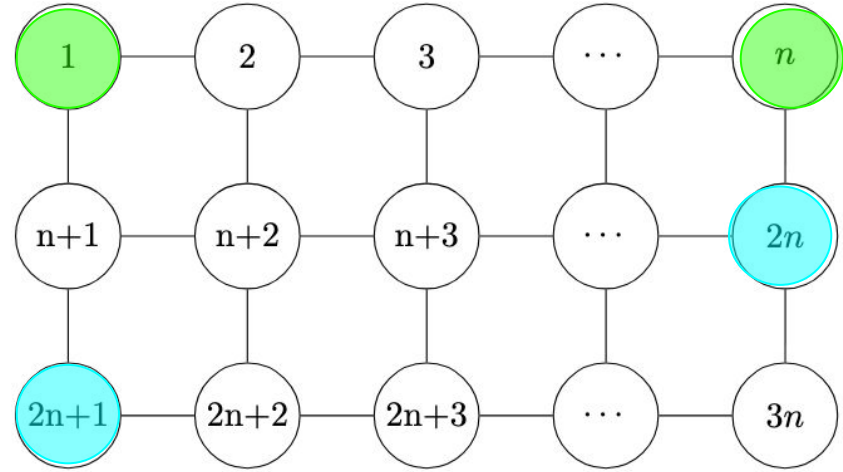


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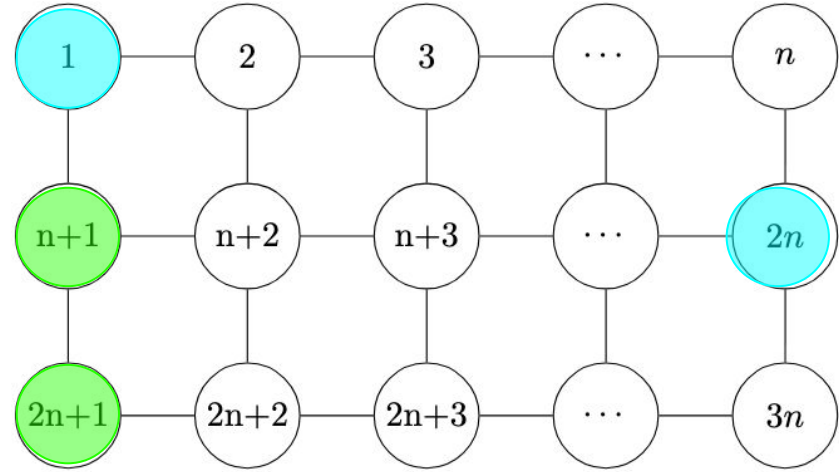


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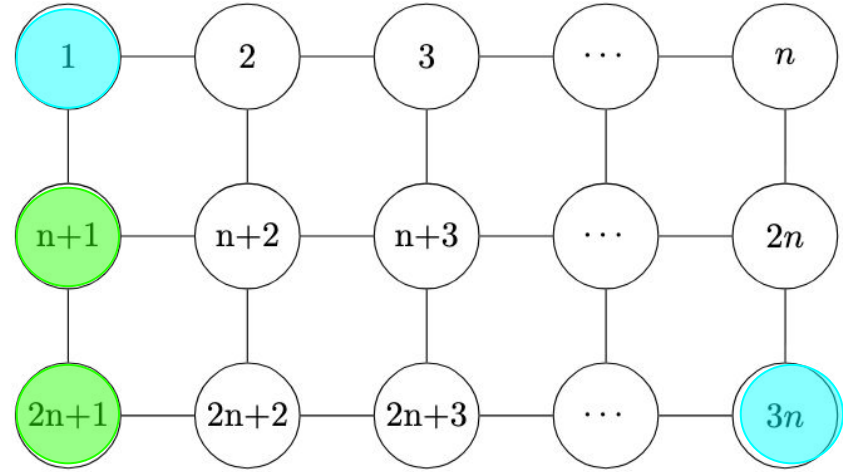


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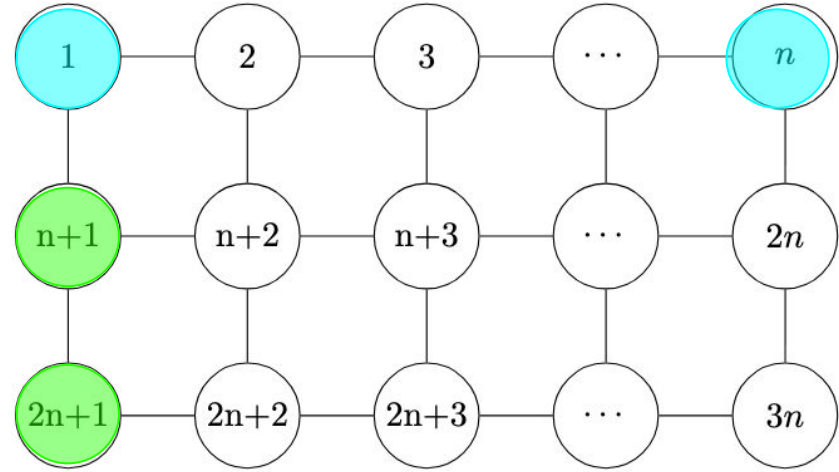


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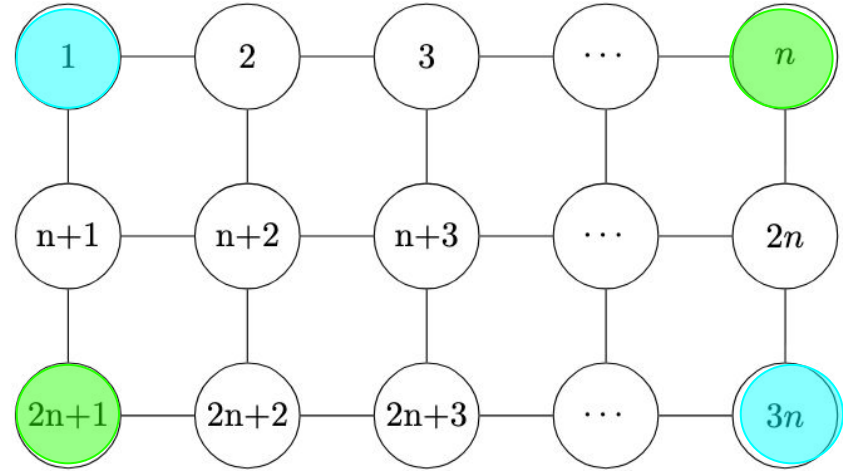


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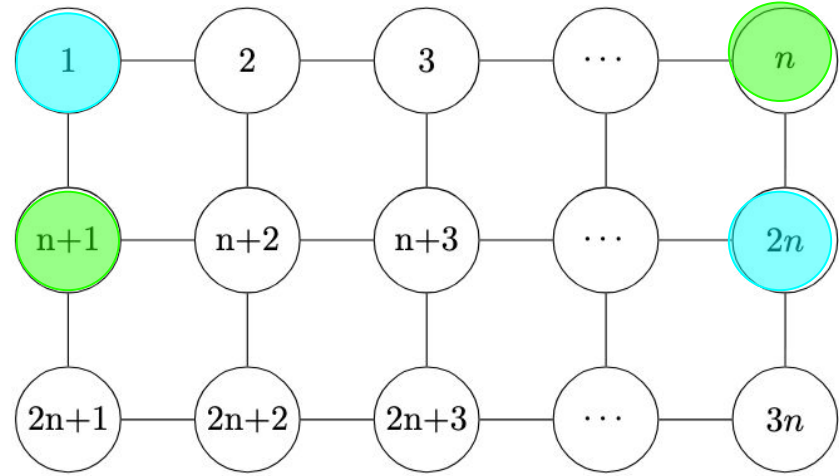


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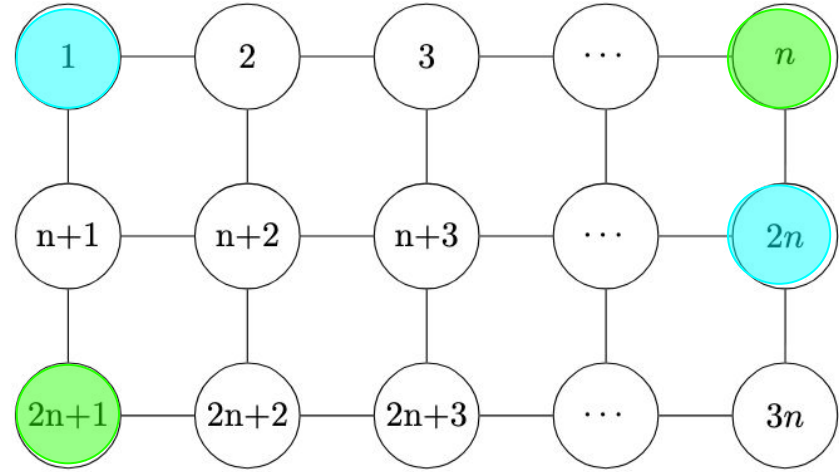


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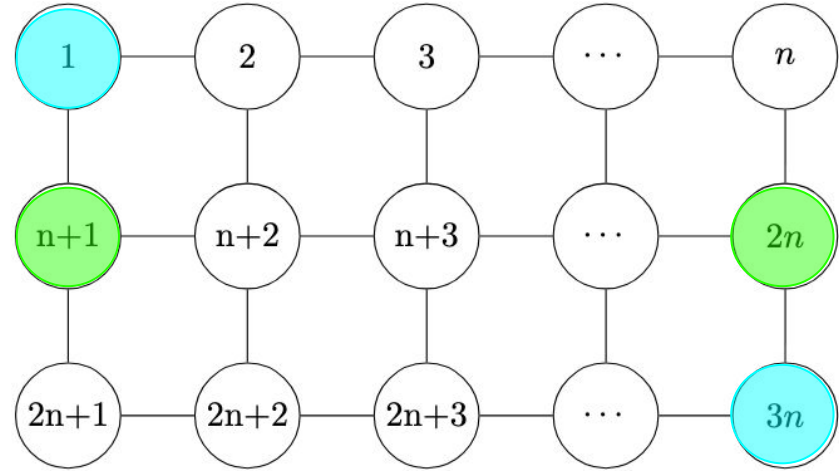


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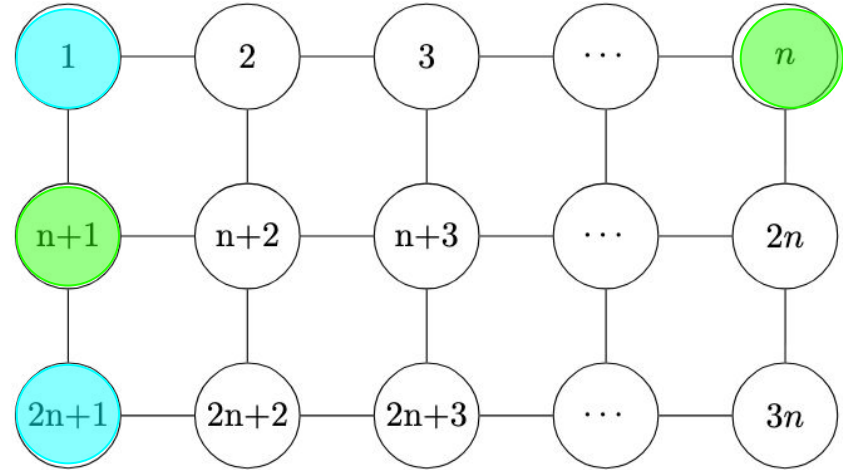


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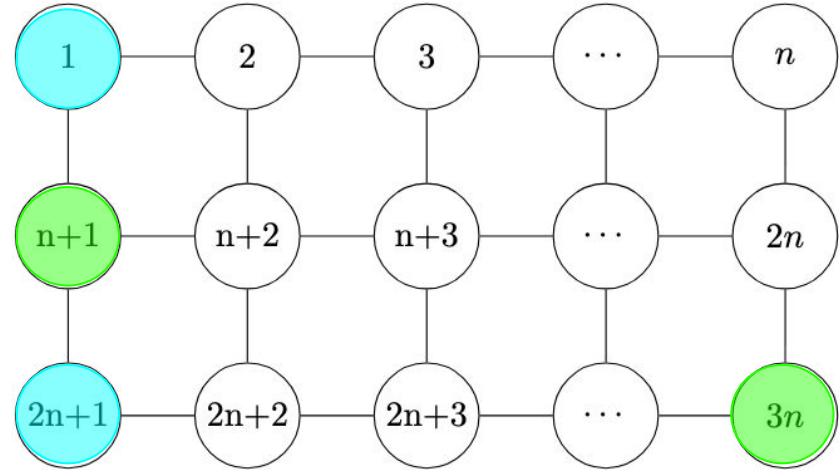


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- $\{1, 2n\}$ & $\{n+1, n\}$ for $n=3$ & $n > 4$
- $\{1, 2n\}$ & $\{2n+1, n\}$ for $n > 2$
- $\{1, 3n\}$ & $\{n+1, 2n\}$ for $n > 5$
- $\{1, 2n+1\}$ & $\{n+1, b\}$, where $b = \{n, 3n\}$ for $n > 2$, and $b = \{2n\}$ for $n > 4$

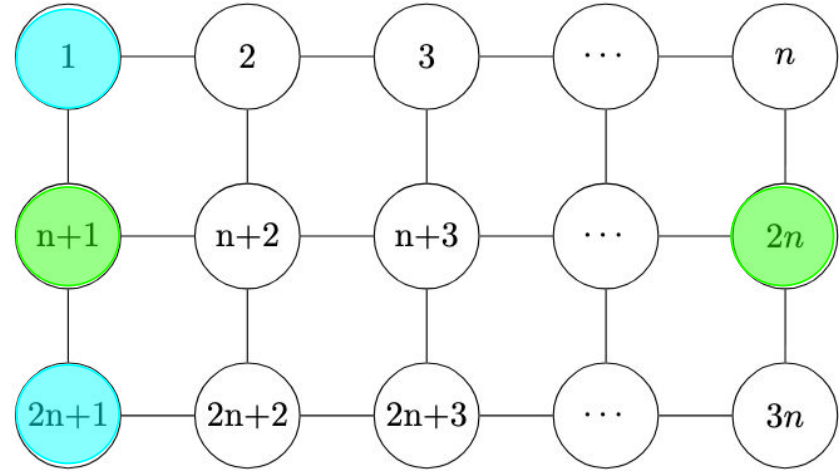
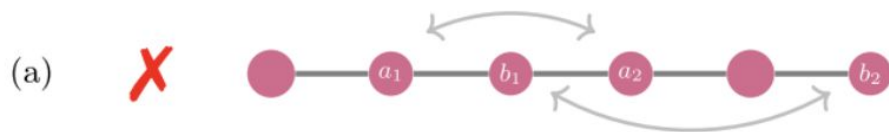


Figure 1: $3 \times n$ Grid

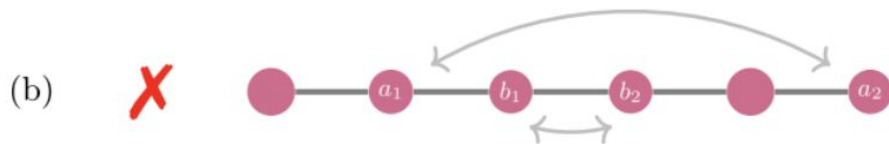
*many of these results can be applied to further similar combinations of the graph based off of symmetry.

Line Graph Bottlenecks

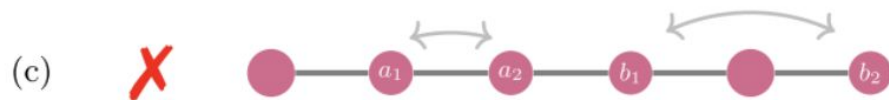
For a line graph, it is impossible to simultaneously extract:



1. “Overlapping” Bell Pairs



2. “Nested” Bell Pairs



3. “Neighboring” Bell pairs

We wanted to see if it was possible to overcome such bottlenecks, when the network is extended to a grid.

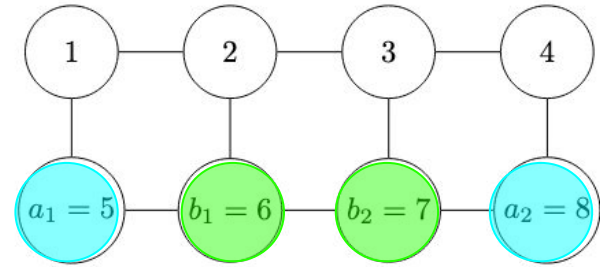
Figure taken from, [\(Zhang 2025\)](#)

Overcoming Line Graph Bottlenecks

When extended to a $2 \times n$ Grid, we found that the following configurations were now extractable:

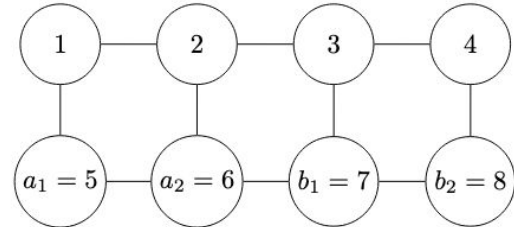
1. Nested Bell Pairs for $n > 3$

- The proof follows by induction using a base case of $n=4$



2. Adjacent Bell Pairs for $n > 3$

- Proof follows by establishing a protocol to split the graph into two sides



Overcoming Line Graph Bottlenecks

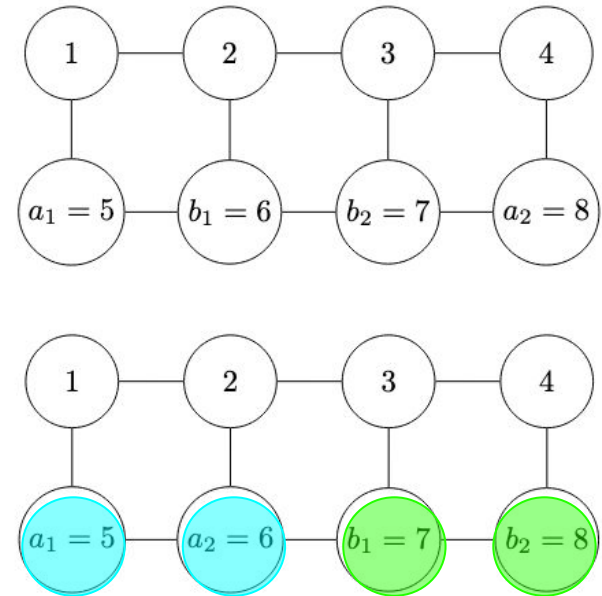
When extended to a $2 \times n$ Grid, we found that the following configurations were now extractable:

1. Nested Bell Pairs for $n > 3$

- The proof follows by induction using a BC of $n=4$

2. Adjacent Bell Pairs for $n > 3$

- Proof follows by establishing a protocol to split the graph into two sides



Overcoming Line Graph Bottlenecks

- We are still unsure if the “overlapping” Bell Pair bottleneck can be relieved by extending to a $2 \times n$ grid
- We suspect that using existing protocols we've created, some cases of overlapping bell pairs can be resolved in a $3 \times n$ grid
- More work will need to be done though to prove such solutions exist

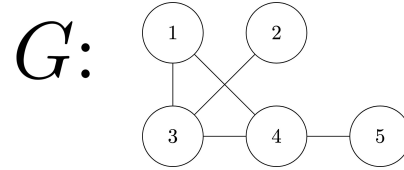
Properties invariant under local complementation

- Cut-rank

- “Amount” of connectedness
- Monotonic with respect to G

- If G' is vertex minor to G, then $\text{cutrk}_{G'}(S) \leq \text{cutrk}_G(S)$

$$\text{cutrk}_G(\{1, 2, 4\}) = \text{rank} \begin{pmatrix} v_1 & v_3 & v_5 \\ v_2 & \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \\ v_4 & \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \end{pmatrix} = 2$$

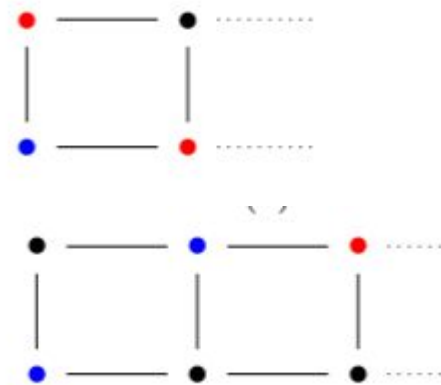


- To show H is not vertex minor to G, we need to find a set whose cut-rank on H is > than on G
- Unfortunately, every cut-rank on a $m \times n$ graph with ≥ 2 in each collection has cut-rank ≥ 2
- For any 4 vertices a, b, c, & d, there is a vertex minor G' such that $\text{cutrk}_{G'}(\{a,c\}) = 2$
- Not possible to distinguish between them.

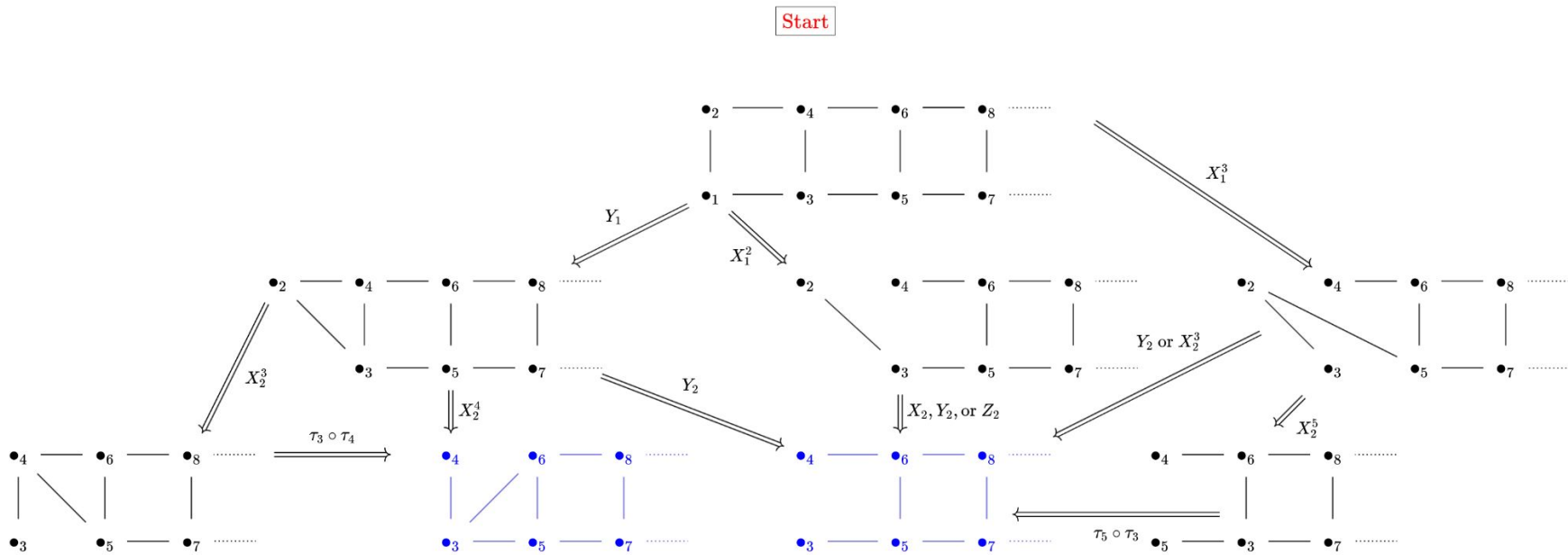
Properties invariant under local complementation

- Local sets

- X is local set of G if $X = S \cup \text{Odd}(S)$
- X a set of vertices of G' , if G' vertex minor to G and X local set of G , then S is a local set of G'
- Contrapositive: S local set of G but not of G' , then G' not vertex minor
- Bell pair graph has no local sets of size 3
- Grids have exactly the above local sets of size 3



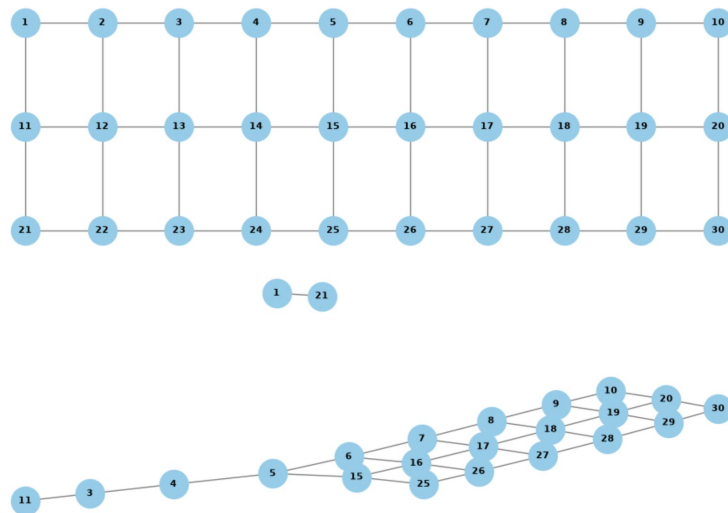
Adding a column



Summary of Progress Made

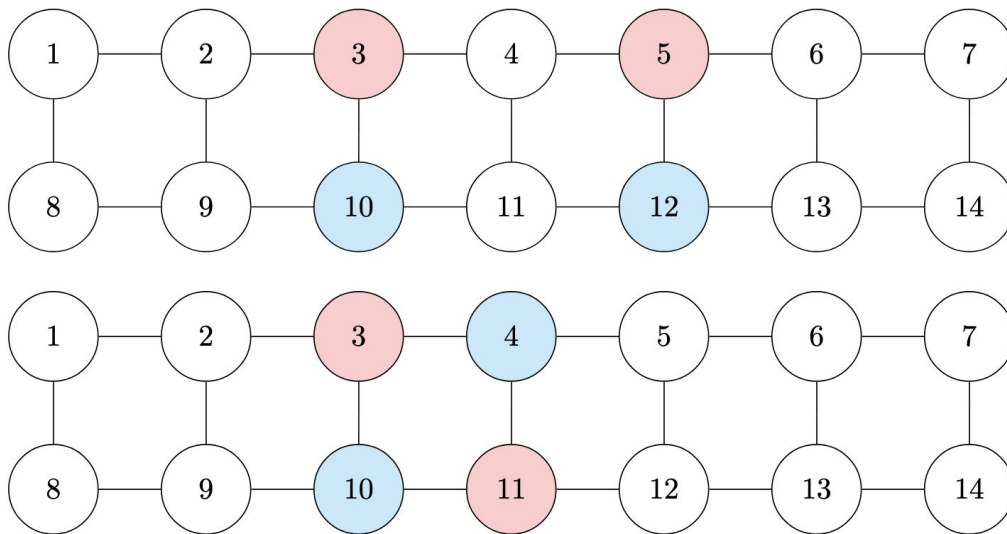
- Programmed code for visualizing graph operations
- Found constructions to extract Bell pairs in many orientations for $2 \times n$ & $3 \times n$ grids
- Found bottlenecks for extracting Bell pairs for $2 \times n$ & $3 \times n$ grids
- Solved tadpole graphs
- Solved some cases in double ring graphs

```
draw_graph(G_int, pos_int, (10,3))
##extract corners
G3 = extract_corners(G_int, cols, show_graph=False, gridlock=True, plot_size=(10,3), position_int=pos_int)
draw_graph(G3, plot_size=(10,3))
```



Open Questions

- Large grids where Bell pair nodes are close together
- Other cases in double ring graphs



Thank you!

- Derek for mentoring us
- Dr. Washington for running the REU program

References

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